

A window to the Future

CRT monitors and LCD panels are passé. The new dawn of display technologies is all about three-dimensional images and foldable displays

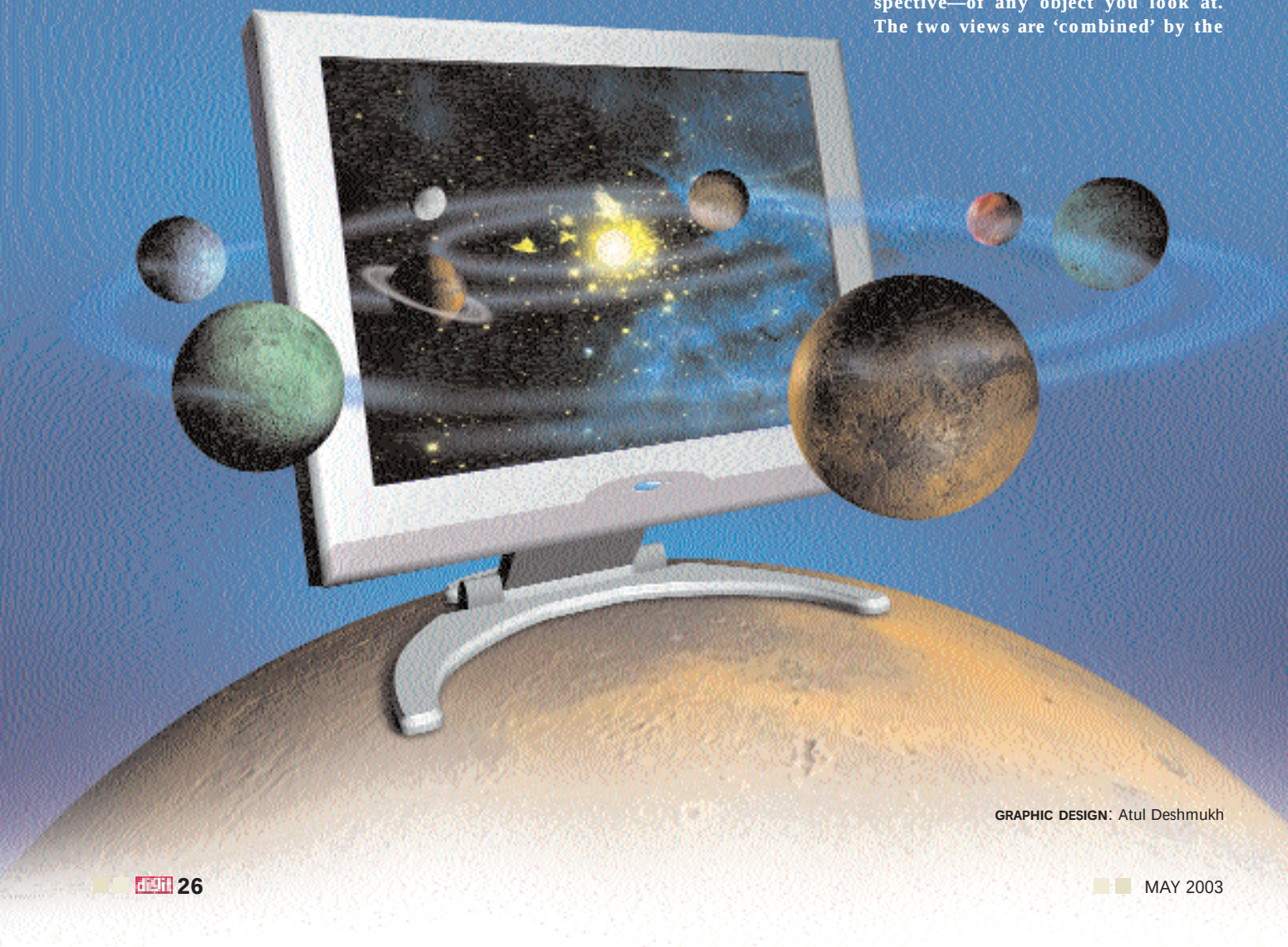
If you were to buy a display today, it will most likely be a CRT monitor or an LCD panel. Both these technologies have been with us for decades, and they certainly beat teletype terminals hands down. But they are bulky, get in the way, require too much care and often demand that we adjust to the display rather than adjust the display to us. It is about time we step beyond the limitations of the

bulky CRT and the fragile LCD.

There are many interesting display technologies vying for a space on your wall, desk and pocket. Some of these will add a new dimension to your visual experience; while others will just plain look better. But each one of these will significantly change the way you look at displays, making possible everything, from outdoor readable e-books to wall-size 3D views.

Real dimensions

We live and think in three dimensions, yet our information representation is, at its best, only 2.5 dimensions—a 3D model printed on paper or rotated in real-time on a 2D monitor. 3D displays have been around for a while, but they require the viewer to wear special spectacles. Because of the distance between the eyes, each eye sees a slightly different view—or perspective—of any object you look at. The two views are ‘combined’ by the



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